

Name: _____

Date: _____

Zoe and the Magpie

Year 3 reading comprehension · Story · 12 marks · About 15 minutes

Every spring, the footpath outside Zoe's school became the scariest place in the world. High in the gum tree by the gate, a magpie had built a nest, and it did not like visitors. Zoe's big brother Harvey walked beside her. "Don't run," he said. "And look at the bird. Magpies swoop less when they can see your eyes."

Zoe's heart thumped. She had been swooped twice last week, and she still remembered the whoosh of wings above her head and the sharp click of a beak. This morning she was wearing her biggest hat, with two huge googly eyes stuck on the back.

"Ready?" asked Harvey. Zoe nodded. They walked quickly towards the gate, and Zoe kept her eyes on the tall gum tree. There was the magpie, perched on a branch, black and white and watching. It turned its head and stared right back at her.

Zoe held her breath. The magpie did not move. She and Harvey walked past the tree, one step, two steps, ten steps, and nothing happened. Zoe let out a giggle of relief.

"See?" said Harvey. "It is not mean. It is only protecting its babies." Zoe peered up and saw a fluffy chick poking its head over the edge of the nest. "Hello," she whispered. "Sorry I was so scared of your family."

1. Where had the magpie built its nest? (1 mark)

2. What does the word "perched" mean in the sentence "perched on a branch"? (1 mark)

3. Write two things Zoe did to feel safer when she walked past the tree. (2 marks)

4. How did Zoe feel as she walked up to the gate? Use a detail from the story to explain how you know. (2 marks)

5. Why do magpies swoop at people in spring, according to the story? (2 marks)

6. How did Zoe feel about the magpie at the end of the story? Give a reason. (1 mark)

7. Number these events 1 to 4 in the order they happen. (2 marks)

- ☐ Zoe sees a chick in the nest.
- ☐ Zoe walks past the tree.
- ☐ Harvey tells Zoe not to run.
- ☐ Zoe's heart thumps.

8. Choose the sentence that best tells what the story is about. Write its letter. (1 mark)

- A. Zoe and Harvey build a big new nest for the magpie in the gum tree.
- B. A magpie chases Zoe all the way through the gate and into her classroom.
- C. Zoe is scared of a swooping magpie but finds out it is protecting its nest.
- D. Harvey and Zoe race each other to the school gate before the morning bell rings.

Answer: _____

Writing task: Write about a time you were scared of something and then found out it was not so scary.
